Find the zipper patterns

How a Zipper Holds Shut and Comes Apart

Name _____ Date _____

Show your thinking with numbers, marks, or words.

1. Big counts zipper teeth in groups of ten. What number comes next?

20, 30, 40, ___

Show your thinking.

2. Little marks the zipper tape every 5 centimeters. What number is missing?

25, 30, ___, 40

Show your thinking.

3. Each time the slider moves, one more pair of teeth meshes: one tooth from each side. Counting teeth by twos, what number comes next?

8, 10, 12, ___

Show your thinking.

Find the zipper patterns

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Name _____ Date _____

Show your thinking with numbers, marks, or words.

4. Little counts the teeth on both sides of the chain, two at a time. What number is missing?

40, ___, 44, 46

Show your thinking.

5. Big counts jacket zippers in a shop, five on each rack. What number comes next?

55, 60, 65, ___

Show your thinking.

6. Little draws 35 zipper teeth, then draws 10 more each time. What number is missing?

35, 45, ___, 65

Show your thinking.

WONDER DAILY

How a Zipper Holds Shut and Comes Apart

A jacket zipper

Above the slider the two sides of a zipper are joined. Below it they hang apart. Each small part has its own job.

Tape, teeth, slider

A zipper has three main parts: the cloth tape, the rows of teeth fixed on it, and the slider that joins or parts the teeth.

Teeth that mesh

Each tooth has a bump and a hollow. The slider squeezes the rows together, so each bump tucks into the next hollow.

A hidden lock

When the pull-tab lies flat, a tiny piece slips between two teeth and holds the slider still. Lifting the tab frees it.

Pin into box

A front jacket zipper comes apart. Its thin pin goes fully into a small box, so both rows start lined up for the slider.

Stops at the ends

A stop at each end keeps the slider from running off the teeth. On a jacket, the box is the stop at the bottom.

Make a little book

1 Fold it into 8 boxes. Open it flat.

2 Fold short end to short end. Cut the thick line. Open it.

3 Fold the long way, pictures out. Push the ends in.

4 Fold into a book. Page 1 goes on the front!

Explain a zipper in your words

How a Zipper Holds Shut and Comes Apart · Curiosity day

Name _____ Date _____

Choose one clue. Say your idea first, then draw or write it.



Teeth that mesh



A hidden lock



Pin into box

Draw two rows of zipper teeth and show where they mesh.

tape · teeth · slider · mesh · chain · retainer box · because · so

The teeth hold together because … where does each bump go?

The slider stays still when … what does the pull-tab do?

The pin must go into the box so … how do the rows start?

Does your sentence tell what happens and use because or so to explain why?